



AUSTRALIA · ASMIRT AND ASAR

Accreditation for sonographers

*How sonographer accreditation works in
Australia, and what it asks of you.*

Ethicare Resourcing

Guide and checklist · October 2026

ethicareresourcing.com

What's inside

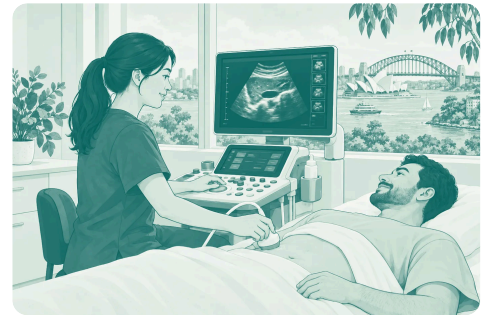
01 Becoming an accredited sonographer

This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Becoming an accredited sonographer

For internationally qualified sonographers. Sonography is not an Ahpra profession: one organisation assesses your qualification, a second accredits you to practise, and the order matters. The checklist is built into the page, so nothing you tick goes out of date.



Who decides

ASMIRT — the Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy — assesses the qualification. ASAR — the Australian Sonographer Accreditation Registry — accredits the practitioner.

Source

The published guidance at asar.com.au and asmirt.org. Where this page and either organisation differ, they are right.

Status

Checked 3 October 2026 against asmirt.org and asar.com.au — the overseas assessments page, the Overseas Assessment FAQs and ASAR's CPD and temporary residents pages. Several ASAR pages are blocked to automated reading, so the Return to Clinical Practice and Accredited Medical Sonographer pages still need checking by hand.

Fees & timings

Deliberately not printed. ASMIRT and ASAR each publish and revise their own; check both before you budget.

AT A GLANCE

Accredited, not registered

Sonography is not a protected title under the National Scheme, so there is no Ahpra board. The route is ASMIRT → ASAR.

ASMIRT first, then ASAR

ASMIRT issues a Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound; that certificate supports your ASAR accreditation. Starting the second before the first is complete wastes time.

Tied to Medicare

An Accredited Medical Sonographer can perform scans that attract Medicare rebates. That is why employers need it – whatever your experience.

No exam to fall back on

If ASMIRT finds your qualification short, the ask is further evidence, more clinical experience or further education – unlike radiography, there is no standard exam to sit.

What's inside

Shorter than the Ahpra guides, because the route is simpler than it sounds. Read it once, then return to each section as you reach it. The checklist at the end remembers what you have ticked, on this device.

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SECTION 01

Why sonography is different

Sonographers do not follow the Ahpra registration pathway. Ahpra, through the Medical Radiation Practice Board, registers diagnostic radiography, radiation therapy and nuclear medicine – not sonography.

Instead, two organisations share the job. ASMIRT assesses your overseas qualification and experience and, if satisfied, issues a Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound. ASAR then accredits you as a practitioner, and that accreditation is what lets you scan under Medicare. Public departments and private practices need an accredited sonographer for exactly that reason, so accreditation is not a formality on top of the job – it is the job.

ASMIRT qualification assessment → Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound → ASAR accreditation → Accredited Medical Sonographer – scan under Medicare

The order matters.

ASMIRT first, then ASAR. ASAR will not accredit you without the ASMIRT certificate, whichever visa you are on – so a well-evidenced ASMIRT application is where almost all of the time you can save sits.

SECTION 02

Step one: ASMIRT assesses your qualification

The Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy is the gateway. It assesses your qualification against the Australian standard as it stood when you qualified, and reaches one of three outcomes.

Outcome 1

Unconditional recognition

Your qualification and experience meet the standard. The Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound is issued and you move to ASAR.

Outcome 2

Conditional

Recognition subject to further evidence or additional clinical experience first. The ask is specific; meet it and the certificate follows.

Outcome 3

Not recognised

The qualification does not currently support recognition. Unlike radiography there is no standard exam to sit instead – the route back is further evidence, more clinical experience or further education.

What ASMIRT needs from you

Your qualification and transcript

Why

The basis of the assessment – what you studied, and against which standard.

Provide

Your ultrasound qualification and the full academic transcript: subjects, results and the grading system.

Tip

Clean colour scans, certified where required, consistent file names.

Recent clinical scanning practice

Why

Recency matters. Skills fade when unused, and ASAR applies its own recency rule later.

Provide

Evidence of recent clinical ultrasound practice – dates, settings and the modalities you scan.

Mistake

A CV that lists roles without making the scanning hours and modalities clear.

Professional references

Why

Independent confirmation of what you say you have done.

Provide

References confirming roles, dates and modalities, from employers or supervisors who can speak to your scanning.

Tip

Brief your referees on what ASMIRT wants confirmed; a warm but vague letter helps no one.

Send us your details before you commit.

Where and what you studied decides which outcome is likely, and we will tell you before you pay an assessment fee. The decision itself is ASMIRT's.

SECTION 03

Step two: ASAR accredits you

Your ASMIRT recognition supports your accreditation with the Australian Sonographer Accreditation Registry. Alongside the certificate, ASAR expects three things.

1

Your ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound

Required. ASAR does not accredit without it.

2

Citizenship, permanent residency or a valid Australian working visa

You must be an Australian or New Zealand citizen, a permanent resident, or hold a valid Australian working visa.

3

Recency of practice

ASAR ties this to time away from clinical ultrasound, not to the age of your ASMIRT certificate. If you have not practised clinical ultrasound for three years or more, its **Return to Clinical Practice Policy** applies and must be met before you resume. The policy sets out what it asks for – read it on ASAR's own site rather than relying on a summary.

Accreditation renews annually.

Fees fall due between 1 and 30 April for both Medical and Student Sonographers. ASAR's published grounds for removal from the Registry are failing CPD requirements and not paying the annual fee, so those are the two things to diarise. Let it lapse and reactivation costs more than renewal.

SECTION 04

Visas, and how the two connect

The ASMIRT certificate does double duty. It is what ASAR needs, and for a skilled-migration visa it also supports the skills assessment the Department of Home Affairs requires.

Most sonographers we place move on an employer-sponsored 482 instead, where the employer sponsors the role and you work toward accreditation alongside. Either way we work with licensed migration advisers; which visa suits you, and what it requires, is their call and Home Affairs' – not ours, and not ASAR's.

Employer-sponsored 482

The route most of the sonographers we place take

The employer sponsors the role. You still need the ASMIRT certificate for ASAR, and your accreditation is renewed each year against a valid visa.

Skilled migration – 189, 190, 491

Points-tested, independent of an employer

The same ASMIRT certificate supports the skills assessment Home Affairs requires. Accreditation still follows through ASAR once you hold the visa or residency.

SECTION 05

English and identity

Two things that do not decide the outcome but can hold it up.

Certified identity documents – passport, and evidence of any name change if your name differs across documents – go in with both applications, together with certified translations of anything not in English. English-language evidence is a requirement of the ASMIRT assessment itself, not something only your visa or employer asks for. ASMIRT accepts IELTS Academic at 7.0 overall with no element below 7.0, OET at B with no element below B, PTE at 66 with no element below 66, or TOEFL iBT at 94 total. Tests must be sat at a venue – home and online tests are not accepted – and completed within the last two years. Time it so the result is still valid when it is needed.

Sitting a test too early.

Assembling ASMIRT evidence takes time, so an early test can expire before it is used. Confirm the requirement and the validity period first.

SECTION 06

Applying, and what happens next

1

Confirm the route and your visa pathway

ASMIRT then ASAR; employer-sponsored or skilled migration. The certificate serves both.

2

Assemble your ASMIRT evidence

Qualification, transcript, recent scanning practice, references, identity – clean, certified, well named.

3

Apply to ASMIRT and pay the fee

Then wait for one of the three outcomes. Respond promptly and completely to any request for more.

4

Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound issued

Keep it safe; ASAR and, for some visas, Home Affairs rely on it.

5

Apply to ASAR

With the certificate, your visa or residency evidence, and recency evidence if the certificate is over three years old.

6

Accredited Medical Sonographer (AMS 1B)

The category overseas applicants are accredited into. Renew annually between 1 and 30 April, and keep your CPD current.

7

Role, sponsorship and the move

Coordinate timelines with your employer. Do not resign or book anything until ASMIRT recognition is confirmed.

How long it takes

Months, not weeks

And the order matters. A complete, well-evidenced ASMIRT application is the biggest factor within your control; starting ASAR before ASMIRT is complete saves nothing.

Fees

Budget for real fees

The ASMIRT qualification assessment, ASAR accreditation and its annual renewal, plus any English test and document certification. Amounts are not printed here – both organisations publish and revise them.

— WHERE PEOPLE GET STUCK

Almost every avoidable delay traces back to one of these

Applying to Ahpra

There is no Ahpra board for sonography. The route is ASMIRT then ASAR.

Starting ASAR before ASMIRT is complete

ASAR will not accredit without the certificate. Sequence, not parallel.

Vague recency evidence

A CV that does not make recent scanning hours and modalities clear – to ASMIRT now, and to ASAR later if the certificate ages past three years.

Referees who cannot speak to your scanning

References must confirm roles, dates and modalities, not just character.

Assuming an exam can rescue a shortfall

Unlike radiography there is none. A conditional outcome asks for evidence, experience or education.

Letting the visa lapse at renewal

Accreditation on a working visa renews each year against a valid visa.

The fix for all of these

Confirm the route, get the ASMIRT evidence right first, line accreditation up with the role and the visa, and have it read by someone else before you submit.

SECTION 08

The questions we are asked most

Do sonographers register with Ahpra?+

Will my overseas qualification be recognised?+

Do I need the ASMIRT assessment whichever visa I am on?+

Can I be accredited before I have a visa?+

What is the recency rule?+

Why does accreditation matter so much?+

How long does it take?+

Can Ethicare review my application?+

SECTION 09

The whole journey on one page

From first decision to first scan. Each stage links to the section that explains it; the checklist tracks the same stages.

Before you start

Confirm the route

ASMIRT then ASAR – not Ahpra. [Section 01](#)

Before you start

Decide the visa pathway

Employer-sponsored or skilled migration; the certificate serves both. [Section 04](#)

Preparing

Assemble ASMIRT evidence

Qualification, transcript, recent scanning practice, references. [Section 02](#)

Applying

ASMIRT assessment

One of three outcomes; respond fully to any request. [Section 02](#)

Milestone

Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound

The document everything else relies on.

Applying

ASAR accreditation

Certificate, visa or residency, recency if needed. [Section 03](#)

Decision

Accredited Medical Sonographer

Scan under Medicare; renew annually.

Then

Role, sponsorship and the move

Where accreditation hands over to [planning your move](#).

THE CHECKLIST

Twenty-two items, in the order you will meet them

Tick as you go. Ticks are saved on this device only – nothing is sent to us – and the list is always the current version, which a downloaded copy never is.

0 of 22 ticked

[Clear all ticks](#)

01 Before you start

Get the shape of the route clear before you spend money.

☐ **Know the route: ASMIRT first, then ASAR** Qualification assessment, then accreditation. Not Ahpra.

☐ **Identify your visa route** Employer-sponsored 482, or points-tested skilled migration (189, 190 or 491). The ASMIRT certificate serves both.

☐ **Note the current fees** ASMIRT assessment, ASAR accreditation and its annual renewal – check the live figures on each organisation's site.

☐ **Check your recency of practice** If your ASMIRT certificate will be over three years old at accreditation, ASAR's recency rule applies.

02ASMIRT qualification assessment

The gateway. Get this moving first.

- ☐ **Your ultrasound qualification, certified** The qualifying award in medical ultrasound or sonography.
- ☐ **Full academic transcript** Subjects, results and the grading system.
- ☐ **Evidence of recent clinical scanning practice** Recency matters — dates, modalities and settings.
- ☐ **Professional references confirming roles, dates and modalities** From employers or supervisors who can speak to your scanning.
- ☐ **Understand the three possible outcomes** Unconditional recognition; conditional — further evidence or clinical experience first; or not recognised.
- ☐ **Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound issued** Keep it safe. ASAR and, for some visas, Home Affairs both rely on it.

03Identity and English

Confirming who you are, and your English where it is required.

- ☐ **Certified identity documents** Passport, plus evidence of any name change.
- ☐ **English-language evidence, where required** Required by ASMIRT, not just by your visa. IELTS Academic 7.0 with nothing below 7.0, or OET B throughout. At a venue, within the last two years.
- ☐ **Certified translations of any non-English documents** Supplied with the certified original.

04ASAR accreditation

Your ASMIRT recognition supports the application.

- ☐ **ASMIRT Certificate of Recognition in Ultrasound** Required — ASAR will not accredit without it.
- ☐ **Citizenship, permanent residency or a valid Australian working visa** One of the three is required.
- ☐ **Meet the recency rule if your certificate is over three years old** About a year part-time or six months full-time in clinical ultrasound within the last three years — or the return-to-practice policy applies.
- ☐ **Submit the accreditation application and fee** Confirm the current figure on ASAR's site first.

05Accredited, and after

What follows accreditation.

- ☐ **Accredited Medical Sonographer status confirmed** You can now scan under Medicare.
- ☐ **Renew annually, 1–30 April** Keep CPD current and pay on time — those are ASAR's published grounds for removal.
- ☐ **Keep your CPD current** Accreditation carries ongoing professional development obligations — check ASAR's current requirements.
- ☐ **Secure your role and confirm sponsorship** Coordinate accreditation and visa timelines with your employer.
- ☐ **Don't make irreversible moves too early** Wait until ASMIRT recognition is confirmed before you resign or book anything.

Print or save as PDF

WHAT NEXT?

Accreditation is one part of the decision

Check my pathwayRegistration and eligibility only – whether ASMIRT is likely to recognise where and what you studied. **How registration works in Australia**For every profession – Ahpra, the boards, ASMIRT and ASAR, English and timelines. **Medical imaging in Australia**The family of professions, and the pages for each. **Sonographer**What the work is like, indicative pay under the state agreements, where the departments are. **Australia or New Zealand?**How the two systems differ for sonographers, on the profession page. **Plan your move**Registration, visas, family and the order to do it in – personalised, saved in your browser.

HOW WE HELP

We line accreditation, the role and the visa up so they don't hold each other up

We review your qualification and experience evidence against what ASMIRT looks for, flag likely issues while they are still easy to fix, and coordinate the sequence with your employer and a licensed migration adviser. The decisions rest with ASMIRT and ASAR.

Talk to Ethicare

[ASAR's own site](#) ↗